

Agelaius xanthomus

yellow-shouldered blackbird

Family (Icteridae)

Kingdom (Animalia)

Status (Endangered)

Description

A blackbird species with entirely black plumage and distinctive yellow shoulder patches (epaulettes). Juveniles show black speckling along the edges of the epaulettes, and adult males are noticeably larger than females. It is an omnivorous species, primarily feeding on insects, especially during the nesting season, but it can also consume a variety of other foods such as fruits, nectar, and human-provided items.



Location/Habitat



Restricted to the southwestern coast of Puerto Rico, the species inhabits low-elevation coastal environments including dry forests, mangroves, scrublands, and areas near lagoons and salt flats. It is associated with arid, open landscapes with scattered vegetation, where it uses trees or mangroves for nesting and nearby open areas for feeding.